

Routers between Rs. 5001 - Rs. 8000

Brand	SMC Networks	Netgear	Buffalo	SMC Networks	D-Link	Linksys	Netgear	Linksys
Model No	SMCWBR11S-3GN	DGN-2200	WBMR-HP-GN	SMCWBR14-3GN	DIR-655	WRT160NL	WNR3500	WAG160N
Price (Rs)	5,500	5,800	6,500	6,500	6,900	7,499	7,900	7,925
Grand Totals (Out of 100)	58.83	49.10	53.00	66.99	62.92	69.69	77.91	73.91
Features (Out of 20)	14.04	13.98	11.8	12.74	14.91	13.19	11.81	13.33
Performance (Out of 80)	44.79	35.12	41.20	54.25	48.01	56.50	66.10	60.58
Features								
Protocols Supported (802.11 a / b / g / Draft n / Draft 2)	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / N / N	N / Y / Y / Y / Y	N / Y / Y / Y / Y	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / Y / Y
Type Of WAN Port (Ethernet / ADSL / USB)	Ethernet	ADSL	ADSL	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	ADSL
No Of RJ45 (LAN) Ports	1	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
No Of USB Ports	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	0
Device Features:								
Power / Connectivity / LAN port / Activity Indicators (Y/N)	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y
Security Indicator / Hardware Security button (Y / N)	N / Y	N / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	N / Y
Factory-Defaults Reset Button (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Wall Mountable (Y/N)	Y	Y	N	N	Y	Y	N	Y
External storage	N	Y	N	N	Y	N	N	N
3G / CDMA / data card feature	Y (3G USB card)	N	N	Y (3G USB card)	N	N	N	N
Security								
Encryption Types	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA2	WPA / WPA2	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WEP / WPA / WPA2
Firewall (Types Supported)	SPI / NAT	NAT	SPI / NAT	NAT	SPI / NAT	SPI	SPI / NAT	SPI
LAN I/P Based Site Blocking (Y/N)	N	N	N	Y	Y	N	N	N
Wireless Isolation (Y/N)	Y	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y
Port Mapping (Forwarding)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Firmware Interface Features:								
Basic Setup Wizard (CD / Browser) (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Online / Offline Firmware Upgrade (Y/N)	Y/Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y
Settings, Backup To HDD / Load From HDD (Y / N)	Y/Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
Ease of Installation/Use (So 10)								
Bundle (Includes Software, except firmware)	6	6	6.5	6	6	6	6	6
Firmware Interface	6.5	6.5	6	6.5	6	6.5	6	6.5
Device Configurable Settings	6	6	6	5.5	6.5	6	6.5	6
Build Quality	5	6	6	5.5	6	6.5	6	6.5
Performance								
Zone 1 (100 MB File transfer)								
Signal Strength in Zone 1 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	66	68	61	61	62.68	65	65	65
Sequential (Mbps)	4.76	1.60	3.39	2.91	4.61	4.97	8.64	6.81
Assorted files (Mbps)	2.92	1.55	1.95	1.67	1.16	3.17	3.71	3.22
Zone 2 (50 MB File transfer)								
Signal Strength in Zone 2 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	40	52	36	43	50	56	55	50
Sequential (Mbps)	2.27	3.52	3.48	4.76	3.57	7.66	7.32	3.49
Assorted files (Mbps)	2.19	1.74	2.43	3.27	2.03	4.23	4.31	2.54
Zone 3 (50 MB File transfer)								
Signal Strength in Zone 3 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	15	25	16	25	18	25	20	23
Sequential (Mbps)	0.12	0	0.58	3.02	0.81	0.83	2.04	2.07
Assorted files (Mbps)	0.39	0	0.52	1.52	0.46	0.55	1.54	1.42
Passmark Performance (Mbps)								
Zone 1	4.76	2.28	2.92	6.15	3.67	4.46	2.5	5.18
Zone 2	3.52	2.73	3.31	4.86	3.12	5.50	3.06	5.80
Zone 3	0.38	0.16	0.55	0.81	1.30	1.33	1.88	1.79
Video Streaming (So 10)								
HD 1080p - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 5	6 / 5 / 3	8 / 8 / 2	8 / 8 / 4	8 / 8 / 8	8 / 8 / 3	8 / 8 / 8	8 / 8 / 8
DVD - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 4	6 / 6 / 4	8 / 8 / 2	6 / 6 / 3	8 / 8 / 5	8 / 8 / 4	8 / 8 / 6	8 / 8 / 3

scenarios. At Rs. 8,999, it's not exactly cheap. Features like USB drive sharing aren't present either.

The Netgear WNDR3700 is a sleeker looking Wi-Fi router. The front panel for example



Buffalo WZR-HP-G300NH

has a layer of transparent plastic with colourful LEDs that blink and reflect on the panel below. The flat design heats up a bit. The interface of the firmware like all other

brands is almost identical to that of the other models.

Performance

The key performers of the category were the Linksys WRT320N, WRT160N and the Netgear WNDR3700.

Their performance was stable in the first two zones. Taking the laptop up to the next floor meant a drastic drop in signal and therefore pathetic transfer speeds from the laptop and the router as well as bad video streaming performance.